

SMARTLEARN AI - ACADEMIC SYSTEM

Program: BSc Business Administration | Course Materials

Course Description & Objectives

This course provides a comprehensive introduction to marketing philosophies, strategies, and structures. Students will examine the role of marketing in society and within firms. Key concepts include understanding customer value, analyzing the marketing environment, market segmentation, target marketing, and the positioning of products/services.

The Four Ps of the Marketing Mix

The marketing mix is the set of tactical marketing tools that the firm blends to produce the response it wants in the target market. It consists of everything the firm can do to influence the demand for its product:

1. **PRODUCT:** The goods and services combination the company offers to the target market (features, design, packaging).
2. **PRICE:** The amount of money customers must pay to obtain the product (discounts, credit terms, pricing strategies).
3. **PLACE:** Company activities that make the product available to target consumers (channels, logistics, inventory).
4. **PROMOTION:** Activities that communicate the merits of the product and persuade target customers to buy it (advertising, sales promotion, PR).

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Module 2: Market Segmentation & Target Audiences

Market segmentation divides a market into distinct groups of buyers who have different needs, characteristics, or behaviors, and who might require separate marketing strategies or mixes. Segments can be based on:

- Demographic factors (age, gender, income, education).
- Geographic factors (nations, regions, states, cities).
- Psychographic factors (social class, lifestyle, personality).
- Behavioral factors (knowledge, attitude, uses, or responses to a product).